

Chapter 75-5

Liang Shi asked Xu Qingzhu, "What are you planning to do?"

"Go home tomorrow," Xu Qingzhu said. "I need to hear what others have to say."

"Do you need me to accompany you?" Liang Shi asked gently.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "No need. Aren't you planning to go to the orphanage tomorrow?"

"I can go another day, if you need me," Liang Shi said. "I'll accompany you."

"No need." Xu Qingzhu shook her head calmly, having already sorted out all her emotions. "Go do your thing. You can't help me with this matter."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Xu Qingzhu, do you think I'm particularly useless?" Liang Shi suddenly asked softly, with a hint of bitterness.

Xu Qingzhu was taken aback. "What are you talking about? Still not sober from the alcohol?"

"No," Liang Shi said. "I just feel like I can't help you with anything."

"How could that be?" Xu Qingzhu said. "You were the one who found out about this first. Besides, Teacher Liang, how do you think you could help me with this kind of family issue tangled up with past grievances?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"I should at least do something for you," Liang Shi said. "You look so....."

Fragile yet strong.

Xu Qingzhu blended these two qualities together very well.

It was rather heartbreaking.

She wanted to do something for her but felt powerless.

"Tonight's noodles and milk were both very good." The corners of Xu Qingzhu's lips curved up as she said warmly, "At times like this, having someone give me a steaming bowl of noodles and a cup of hot milk is the greatest help. Thank you, Teacher Liang."

As she spoke, she even bent at the waist and gave a mock bow.

Liang Shi: "....."

"Teacher Liang," Xu Qingzhu suddenly raised an eyebrow. "Are you using the alcohol as an excuse to fish for compliments?"

Liang Shi: "No! That's not it! Impossible!"

A very emphatic triple denial.

But Xu Qingzhu laughed. "Alright, understood. Teacher Liang's noodles tonight were very delicious. I ate until I was very full."

Liang Shi: "....."

For some reason, her ears felt hot listening to this.

"Oh, right." Xu Qingzhu held her milk and stood up, preparing to go upstairs. Before turning around, she patted Liang Shi's shoulder. "Teacher Liang is very decisive, has high aesthetic taste, and is very considerate of others. It was out of unconditional trust that I handed over the heavy responsibility of house-hunting entirely to Teacher Liang."

"Also, Teacher Liang is very useful," Xu Qingzhu continued. "Without Teacher Liang, how could I highlight my composure while watching horror movies?"

Liang Shi: ".....!!!"

After saying that, Xu Qingzhu went upstairs.

Liang Shi belatedly realized what had happened and suddenly smiled while watching her retreating figure.

Although she had been passive-aggressively teased, Xu Qingzhu's mood should have been adjusted by now.

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To prove that she wasn't actually that scared, before bed, Liang Shi compiled a list of horror movies and sent it to Xu Qingzhu.

She had put a lot of effort into compiling it—just from the stills and synopses, they looked extremely terrifying.

Liang Shi: 【Teacher Xu, if you can't sleep, you can watch these slowly.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【.....】

Liang Shi: 【If you're scared, you can call me.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【.....】

Liang Shi: 【If you're really, really scared, you can come watch in the living room... I can too.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Don't know what to say.jpg】

A few seconds later, Xu Qingzhu sent a 3-second voice message. Her voice carried a hint of amusement, her cool tone rising, lingering and melodious: "Teacher Liang, go to sleep. Good night."

Liang Shi: "....."

She listened to this voice message three times over and over, then finally tapped the screen with trembling fingers: 【Okay, Teacher Xu. Good night.】